

LIFE & SELF-DEVELOPMENT

7 Simple Habits That Quietly Rewired My Productivity

The exhaustion of chasing perfect systems — and the quiet relief of returning to habits honest enough to survive your worst days.

THE PROBLEM

Why Productivity Systems Fail

- ✓ They require a perfect structure across an imperfect life
- ✓ Complexity collapses on hard days
- ✓ The fix: habits simple enough to survive your worst day

HABIT 1

The Shutdown Ritual

- ✓ Four minutes: scan tasks, note what's open, write one line on what got done
- ✓ Say out loud: "Shutdown complete"
- ✓ Gives your nervous system a real closure signal — brains fixate on open loops until you do

HABIT 2

The Weekly Brain Dump

- ✓ 20 minutes, once a week — write everything in your head
- ✓ No organization, no categories, just out
- ✓ Offloading frees cognitive resources for actual thinking

HABIT 3

Eat One Frog

- ✓ Identify your most dreaded task the night before
- ✓ Do it first — and only one
- ✓ Avoidance runs in the background like an open program; one frog closes it

HABIT 4

The Done List

- ✓ At day's end, write the 5 most meaningful things you did
- ✓ Not everything — what moved something
- ✓ Corrects your estimate of your own capacity over time

HABIT 5

One 90-Minute Deep Work Block

- ✓ First 15–20 minutes are on-ramp; short blocks end right as you hit stride
- ✓ Each context switch costs 15–20 minutes of recovery time
- ✓ One protected block beats four fragmented Pomodoros for output quality

HABIT 6

Write Tomorrow's Top 3 Tonight

- ✓ Three priorities, written the night before — three forces a choice, five doesn't
- ✓ Night-before planning uses full context; morning planning uses depleted decision capacity
- ✓ Morning-you should never decide what to work on — past-you already did

HABIT 7

Track One Metric Per Week

- ✓ One number — whatever matters most this week
- ✓ Tracking ten things creates measurement overhead that becomes its own procrastination
- ✓ What gets measured gets noticed. Noticing is most of the work.